Agent payment rules, November 2026

Three regulators. One question.

Who answers for a payment an AI agent made?



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United Kingdom | Proposed

A trust framework, still being shaped.

- July: recommendation 10 of the Financial Services AI Adoption Plan calls for a trust framework for agentic payments.
- Three pillars: legal and liability frameworks, Know Your Agent protocols, authentication and governance.
- A consultation on payment services regulation closed on 6 October. It asks what may need to change on authentication, consent and liability.

Sources: HM Treasury, Financial Services AI Adoption Plan, July 2026; HM Treasury consultation on modernising payment services regulation.

Hong Kong | Exploring

Project SAGE, launched this week.

The HKMA set out four focus areas:

- Use cases: consumer, business and machine-to-machine payments.
- Agent identity: Know Your Agent practices and delegated authority.
- Interoperability standards.
- Legal and regulatory: governance, liability and consumer protection.

An expert group supports it. Preliminary results are expected in 9 to 12 months.

Sources: HKMA, 2 November 2026, via Financial IT; Caixin Global for the timeline.

China | In effect for members

An industry convention, not a statute.

The Payment and Clearing Association of China issued it in August. Members should:

- Build a Know Your Agent mechanism modelled on KYC.
- Set authorization boundaries and sign liability allocation agreements with users.
- Verify user identity and transaction intent.
- File with the association before launching agentic payments.

Sources: Yicai Global, 25 August 2026; Linklaters Asia fintech and payments bulletin, September 2026.

Different status. The same three questions.

Which agent is this?

UK	Know Your Agent protocols
HK	Agent identity, KYA practices
CN	KYA mechanism alongside KYC

What was it allowed to do?

UK	Consent rules under review
HK	Delegated authority
CN	Authorization boundaries

Who carries the loss?

UK	Liability frameworks
HK	Liability, consumer protection
CN	Liability allocation agreements

Our reading of the documents on the previous slides.

None of this is settled. The questions are.

Whatever the rules become, a dispute will come down to the record. For every agent payment, it helps to be able to show:

- Which agent paid
- Who it acted for
- What instruction it followed
- Which mandate or proof came with it
- Where the evidence stops

What we publish

Keep the answers in one open format.

APE v0.1 is an open, rail-neutral record of one agent payment: the agent, the owner, the instruction, the payment and the proofs. Apache-2.0.

github.com/halvorAI/ape-schema

Our reading, not legal advice.



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